HEROES OF NORMANDIE

The Devil Pig News

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EASY COMPANY

All right, you bastards, listen up! It's time to discuss the men of Easy Company, 506th Parachute Infantry Regiment, the best-known group of parachutists in American history. You've all seen the show on HBO, and most of you have probably read the book by Steven Ambrose, so let's dive right in to get a quick overview of the men who brought American arms to the aid of the Allies in Europe in 1944. GERONIMO!

The 506th was one of several light infantry regiments organized during America's run-up to entry in World War Two. Although the Soviets had actually pioneered the parachute infantry concept before the war, up until the boys of the 506th came out of Toccoa, Georgia, only the Germans were really using parachute infantry in any numbers. Although Hitler loved his Fallschirmjaeger, after the horrendous losses they'd taken at Crete in May of '41, the German parachutists were mostly prohibited from making combat drops. The American organization of the 506th meant that it would continue to be ready to make combat jumps all the way up to the very end of the war, despite losses. The 506th's only commander was Colonel Robert Sink, a tough and competitive old guy who'd come to the Airborne in 1940 and made it a point to lead from the front. Hard as nails, Sink actually continued to celebrate his birthday every year by jumping out of an airplane, and was one of a handful of master parachutists in the American Army.

Easy Company, of HBO fame, participated in most of the big battles in Europe, including the D-Day drop, the ill-fated Operation Market Garden, the Bulge and Bastogne, and even the final battles in Germany in April of 1945. If the Allies had decided to go with their plans to attack mainland Japan, the 506th would have been in the line for that operation as well. According to Easy's most famous leader, Major (then-Captain) Richard Winters, Easy had three rifle platoons and a headquarters section. Each platoon had three twelve-man squads at full strength, not that they were ever at full strength after D-Day. There was also a six-man 60mm mortar squad, and a .30 machinegun attached to each squad. Trained to within an inch of their lives, many of the men of Easy recalled actually being relieved to get into Normandy in order to get away from the exhausting training regime.

Winters was a natural leader, and there was much recorded friction between him and Easy's assigned commander, Herbert Sobel. A near-mutiny by the company's senior NCOs caused Colonel Sink to reassign Sobel, and command was given to Winters after the new boss, Lieutenant Meehan, was killed when his plane was shot down on D-Day. It was an excellent decision, in view of the outcome. Winters guided his men through most of the war until promoted to higher command; he was well-known for his concern for his men and for his tactical expertise. One of his small-unit actions, the assault on the German guns at Brecourt, is still used as an example in American military academies today.



Easy was full of characters, like any other military unit, and it would be impossible to name them all here. Junior officers like Buck Compton and, Ed Foley, and Harry Welsh all served under Winters as reliable comrades who could take orders and lead men, and strong NCOs like Carwood Lipton (eventually promoted to officer status), Joe Toye, and Donald Malarkey gave the command the strength and flexibility it needed to succeed. All the way from top to bottom, Easy was an outstanding example of what parachute infantry could do when properly trained and motivated, and their battle record speaks for itself.



Using Easy in a game of HoN is simple to arrange, as they were present in most of the key conflicts in the European theater. Frequently under-supplied and over-exposed, Easy often fought forces larger than their own, or in positions that had to be held at all costs.

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SCENARIO 1- BRIEFING

RENDEZVOUS

The big day has barely begun, and it's already a complete mess. The men are scattered to the four corners of Normandy, the divisions are all mixed together, and the equipment is mostly lost.... Winters is rounding up the soldiers he finds along the way. The ragtag group makes its way to the rendezvous point, but the German defenses are finally in place. These first hours are not going to be a walk in the park!

1- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT



TERRAIN TILES : C4-A/C1-B/C5-B - C3-A/C2-A/C6-A

2- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES





3- PREPARATION

Without looking at them, place **2** Bonus tactic markers.

Remove the following cards from both decks:
Don't Stop!, Repairs, Precision, It Bounced Right Off It, Weak Point, Hit and Run, Ram, all the **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards.

The German player deploys first.

The American player has initiative. Place the corresponding marker on space **1** of the turn counter.

Each player draws **4** cards.

4- PLAYING THE GAME

The game lasts **6** turns.

The American player will bring his units into play through the spaces indicated by the green arrows. He **cannot have 2** units enter through the same place in the same turn.

The American player's goal is to control the primary objective and one of the two secondary objectives before the end of turn **6**.

The game comes to an end if the American player controls these objectives at the end of a Supply Phase.

5- END OF THE GAME AND VICTORY

AMERICAN VICTORY: The American player wins the game if he controls his objectives before the end of turn **6**.

GERMAN VICTORY: The German player wins the game if the American player does not control his objectives at the end of turn **6**.

SCENARIO 2- BRIEFING

CARENTAN, AND AFTER THAT?

Carentan has been taken, but the Germans are launching a counterattack. The first few minutes of fighting seem to give the advantage to the men of Easy Company. Suddenly the rumbling of tanks can be heard. Winters manages to keep the front line cohesive. The orders are clear: "Hold this position at any cost". But for how long?

1- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT



TERRAIN TILES : C1-B/C6-B/C4-B - C3-A/C2-A/C5-A

2- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES





3- PREPARATION

Without looking at them, place **2** Bonus tactic markers.

Remove the cards Surprise and all the **Artillery** and **Aviation** cards from both decks.
Remove the card Precision, Booby-trapped and Return to sender from the German deck.

The American player deploys his troops in his deployment zone.
The German player has initiative.
Place the corresponding marker on space **1** of the turn counter.
Each player draws **4** cards.

4- PLAYING THE GAME

The game lasts **7** turns.
The German player will bring his units into play through the spaces indicated by the blue arrows.
The German player must control his primary objective before the end of turn **7**. Only infantry units can take control of the objective.

Turn 4: The American player's reinforcements come into play through the spaces marked with green arrows.

END The game ends if the German player controls his objective at the end of a Supply Phase.

5- END OF THE GAME AND VICTORY

AMERICAN VICTORY: The American player wins the game if the German player does not control his objective at the end of turn **7**.
It is a **major** victory if the American player additionally controls his secondary objective.
Only infantry units can take control of the objective.

GERMAN VICTORY: The German player wins the game if he controls his objective before the end of turn **7**.

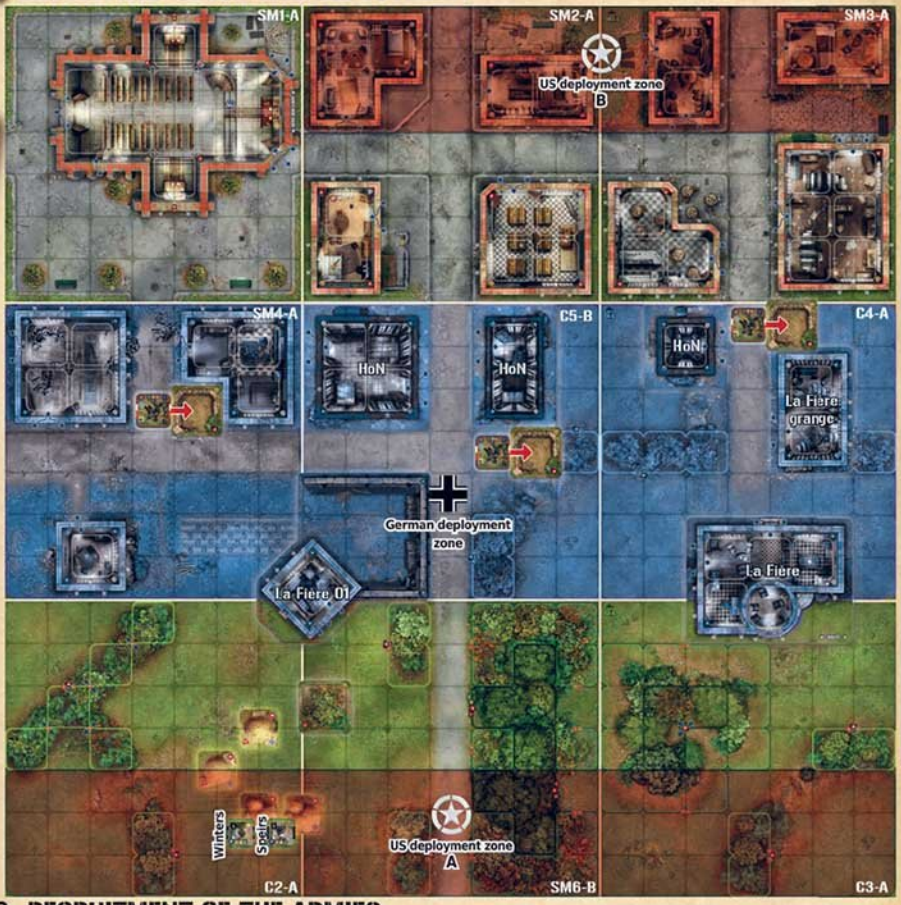


SCENARIO 3- BRIEFING

RUN SPEIRS, RUN!

Village of Foy, December 1944. Dike's lack of initiative has nailed his men to the ground, under fire from the Germans hidden in the village. The paratroopers are pinned down in open ground, and the situation threatens to get worse. They really need to relay a workaround order to the other elements of Easy, but those guys don't have a radio, and they are on the other side of the German defense. Speirs volunteers, and rushes to deliver this vital order....

1- BATTLEFIELD SETUP AND DEPLOYMENT



TERRAIN TILES : SM1-A/SM2-A/SM3-A - SM4-A/C5-B/C4-A - C2-A/SM6-B/C3-A

2- RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

GROUP A



GROUP B



You must have the **Sainte-Mère-Église** expansion to play this scenario.
You can download the *"Haystacks"* player aid from our website, or use the tokens from the **Fortified Farm** expansion.